LANDLORDLEDGER · RED FLAGS · FREE CHECKLIST

TENANT SCREENING CHECKLIST

3 red flags + 1 pro tip for landlords. Same rules for every applicant.

RED FLAG #3: RUSH + CASH

- [ ] Wants to move in today, offers months up front in cash
- [ ] Slow down: complete every check before handing over keys

RED FLAG #2: UNVERIFIABLE INCOME

- [ ] No pay stubs, bank statements, or offer letter
- [ ] Employer or income source can't be reached

RED FLAG #1: NO LAST-LANDLORD CONTACT

- [ ] Won't give a prior landlord's name or number
- [ ] Contact info that only reaches a friend or relative

MY WRITTEN CRITERIA (SAME FOR EVERYONE)

- [ ] Income minimum _____ Credit / history standard _____
- [ ] Required documents _____ Application fee _____
- [ ] Order of checks: application income landlord reference decision

PRO TIP

- [ ] Use the exact same written criteria, in the same order, for every applicant
- [ ] Fair housing: never decide based on race, color, religion, sex, national origin, disability, or family status
- [ ] Check state and city rules (some limit criminal-history or income-source questions)
- [ ] **BONUS: the question for the last landlord: revealed in the next Red Flags episode**

General information only, not legal, tax, financial, or professional advice. Rules vary by state and city.
Free to use and share · Red Flags